CROQUETAS DE PUERRO CONFITADO

YIELD	ACTIVE TIME	REST
4 people (~20 croquetas)	**40 min**	**Fridge, 24 h ideally**

INGREDIENTS

1	Large puerro (leek), white part only
1 l	Whole milk
75 g	Wheat flour
75 g	Butter
1 pinch	Salt and nutmeg
plenty	Extra virgin olive oil (to confit the leek)
as needed	Egg and breadcrumbs (for coating)
as needed	Extra virgin olive oil for frying

METHOD

1. Confit the leek. Chop the white part fine and cook it in plenty of oil over the lowest heat for about 30 min, until it is nearly a paste. Drain.
2. Melt the butter, add the drained leek, then stir in the flour and toast it.
3. Pour in the milk gradually, stirring constantly, and cook the bechamel about 40 min until it pulls away from the pan. Add the nutmeg and salt.
4. Spread out, cover, and chill in the fridge. 24 h is ideal.
5. Shape and coat in egg and breadcrumbs.
6. Fry in properly hot oil until golden. Drain.

NOTES

Roux is 1:1 by weight (75 g flour : 75 g butter) to 1 l milk. That is the same roux as the queso azul recipe carrying a third more milk, which is why the bechamel here needs 40 min rather than 20.
Confiting the leek on the lowest heat concentrates its sweetness. The source treats this as the step that makes the recipe.
A pinch of bicarbonate speeds the confit up.
Drain the oil off the leek properly before it goes into the bechamel.
Long rest, 24 h preferably, for a mass you can handle.
Keep the green part of the leek for stock.
Inspired by Oído Cocina.
Header calls for deep oil.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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